

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Brief explanation :

- In humans and other primates , the ventral , posterior (dorsal) aspects of the cortex mature and develop much later than the posterior neuro axis (brain stem). This includes the auditory (primary auditory cortex), motor (efferent representation of primary motor cortex), somatosensory , and parietal areas , which correspond to the visual and limbic sensory modalities .
- By birth , these cortices contain only a few neurons , and their corticocortical connections and even synaptogenesis are incomplete compared with the posterior neuro axis .
- The brain stem and posterior neuro axis contain the majority of neurons at birth and support normal breathing and reflexes ; cranial nerves emerge during fetal development .

Why not the other structures ?

- Thalamus , cerebellum , basal ganglia , limbic system , and hypothalamus contribute to brain function early in development but are not specifically ‘least developed’ at birth compared to the cortical structures .
- The parietal lobe is not the correct term here ; the parietal cortex is involved , but the more generally representative answer is the cortices in general .

Therefore , at birth , the least developed part of the brain is the cortex .

</think>

<answer>

G . cortex

</answer>

